

c. August 1940

The following is a faithful transcription of an excerpt from a letter written by Fr. Solanus Casey, OFM Cap. to his brother, Msgr. Edward Casey, c. August 1940. This excerpt is found quoted in a letter of Msgr. Edward Casey to his brother, James Casey and dated August 7, 1940. Excerpt, from page 2 of Msgr. Edward Casey's letter is as follows:

Father Solanus (Msgr. Edward writes) in a beautiful letter received a few days ago, tells of your doings (James) in an earlier day. In a reminiscent mood he writes:

"Maurice and I have always been together. Almost as early as I can remember I used to innocently envy him because they spoke of him as destined to be the priest and I would wonder if it were not possible for me to be priest too. We chummed together and in time of harvest and stacking when he had to help Ellie and James to bind the wheat, etc. I would pride myself on being his "hazel-nut picker", supplying him with shelled nuts from hills and nooks where they grew in abundance. Sometimes I'd even give them to him already cracked. Those were the days when oxen, slow creatures, were gradually being supplanted by horses, and reapers were looking over their shoulders at the harvesters and self-binders following on their heels as they themselves followed the old cradles out of commission."

"Help was nearly always scarce from about June to some time in September, and during the days of stacking, dear Mother-Requiescat in Domino- would insist on coming out when a load come in, and help Jimmie to pitch off while Maurice would pass bundles to Papa stacking. Later on we'd rove the pasture lands - fishing, swimming, studying our Catechism and often getting into mischief while supposed to be keeping an eye on the cattle, as was done of old when the sons of Jacob were herdsmen."

NOTA BENE: -original letter of Fr. Solanus to
Msgr. Edward is no longer extant -